20

INDIA’S ROLE IN SECURING THE WORLD

24 JUNE 2021

INDIA | 6,15,055 ACTIVE CASES | 3,98,022 DEATHS | 24.76 CRORE VACCINE DOSES

WORLD | 1,13,06,942 ACTIVE CASES | 39,32,708 DEATHS | 176 CRORE VACCINE DOSES

The second wave subsided as swiftly as it rose, making almost a vertical decline on the curve. All markers had begun to show that we were almost out of the grip of the second tsunami of cases. Many, many families had lost their loved ones this time around. In parts of India where the cases were unequally concentrated, everyone had closely experienced the struggle to procure beds, essential medicines or oxygen. Those horrifying memories weren’t going to fade easily.

To be fair, in retrospect, no expert around the world had predicted this velocity and almost a vertical rise of a second surge of infections in India. As mentioned earlier, on the contrary, most of them had begun to release data in February 2021 indicating that the virus was on a subsiding trajectory in India.

It is rather unfortunate that India was so politically fractured during a time of a once-in-a-century global crisis and that people had to see such low-level politics play out. Political parties, their leaders, chief ministers, spokespersons, everyone had no qualms in unreservedly lying to the people about important issues which would impact the nation’s state of mind during dealing with the pandemic. While we saw politics play out in other countries as well where governments have been under fire for their pandemic responses, it never got to a point where a leader of a nation was constantly shamed and ferociously attacked in the international press like